

Pricing Strategy: Who Can Spend the Less?

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Strategy type: Hybrid – Freemium base with league-owner-paid subscription tiers.

Why this structure: The product is a social group game, so the group is what you sell, not the individual. A free tier lets any friend group start without friction, and that growth drives joins. One person (the league owner) pays to unlock the things that make the game stickier: Wrapped emails, stakes and bigger groups. Subscription fits because the daily-upload habit recurs.

Tier Overview

Tier	Monthly	Annual (-20%)	Members	Key unlocks
Mates (Free)	£0	£0	4	1 league, weekly board, 20 scans/member/mo
Squad (hero)	£3.99	£38.30	12	3 leagues, Wrapped emails, reminders, stakes, unlimited scans
Society	£9.99	£95.90	50	Unlimited leagues, seasons, CSV export, Opus parsing

The Tiers

Mates (Free)

Price: £0

Who it's for: A flat or small group of 3–4 friends trying the app for the first time.

What's included: 1 league, up to 4 members, weekly leaderboard, screenshot parsing capped at 20 scans per member per month, manual and cash entries, basic badges, challenges.

Left out on purpose: Wrapped emails, daily reminders, stakes and missed-day penalties, monthly leaderboards.

Price justification: Cost to serve is only the capped AI scans on the cheap claude-haiku-5-5 model, a fraction of a penny each. Useful enough to get a group hooked.

Squad (hero tier)

Price: £3.99/mo | £38.30/yr (save 20%)

Who it's for: A house or course-mates group of 5–12 who want the full competitive experience.

What's included: Up to 12 members, 3 leagues, unlimited scans (fair use), weekly and monthly leaderboards, emailed weekly and monthly Wrapped, daily reminders, missed-day penalties, budget targets and stakes, all badges.

Price justification: The owner pays £3.99; a group of 5 splits it to about 80p each, which feels like a round of drinks. A .99 price suits a price-sensitive student market.

Society

Price: £9.99/mo | £95.90/yr (save 20%)

Who it's for: Uni societies, halls of residence, or workplace teams with 13–50 members.

What's included: Everything in Squad, plus up to 50 members, unlimited leagues, term-long seasons, CSV export of the audit trail, claude-opus-5-5 parsing for messier screenshots.

Price justification: About 2.5× Squad's price for about 4× the members. It also makes £3.99 look reasonable next to it.

Positioning & Psychology

- **Market position:** Value leader with a fun, social angle. Competitor prices were not verified; this assumes budgeting apps are the nearest anchor. Check before launch.
- **Anchoring and decoy:** Society makes Squad the obvious middle choice.
- **Charm pricing (£3.99):** Suits a student audience.
- **Loss aversion:** After a month on Free, groups have streaks and history they would lose by staying without Wrapped.
- **Social cost-splitting:** Show '£0.80 each for 5 people' at checkout.
- **Upgrade triggers, Free to Squad:** the 5th member joining, the first Wrapped teaser, or hitting the 20-scan cap.
- **Upgrade triggers, Squad to Society:** the 13th member, or wanting a second term-long season.

Revenue Optimization

- **Wrapped teaser:** Show Free users a blurred or locked Wrapped on the first Monday. The strongest upsell moment.
- **Term Pass:** A one-off £9.99 Squad pass per term (about 3 months) alongside monthly and annual. Students think in terms, and it avoids summer churn.
- **Sponsor button:** Let any member pay for the league, not just the owner, with a 'split the bill' prompt.
- **Cost control:** Free tier on claude-haiku-5-5, paid tiers on claude-opus-5-5 only where it matters.

Biggest Pricing Risk

Opus parsing cost on Squad. PLAN.md says Opus is 'well under a cent' per scan. A heavy 12-member league uploading daily is about 360 scans a month. At 1p per scan that is £3.60, nearly the whole £3.99 before payment fees. Mitigate by defaulting Squad to Haiku, reserving Opus for Society or low-confidence retries, and tracking cost per league from the first paying customer.

Assumptions

- Currency is GBP, not the skill's USD default, because the project is UK-based.
- Competitor pricing is unverified.
- Payment processing fees are not included in the margin figures.
- Goal is side income: 100 paying Squads would be about £400/mo before costs.
- No FOUNDER_CONTEXT.md existed; README.md and PLAN.md were used as context.